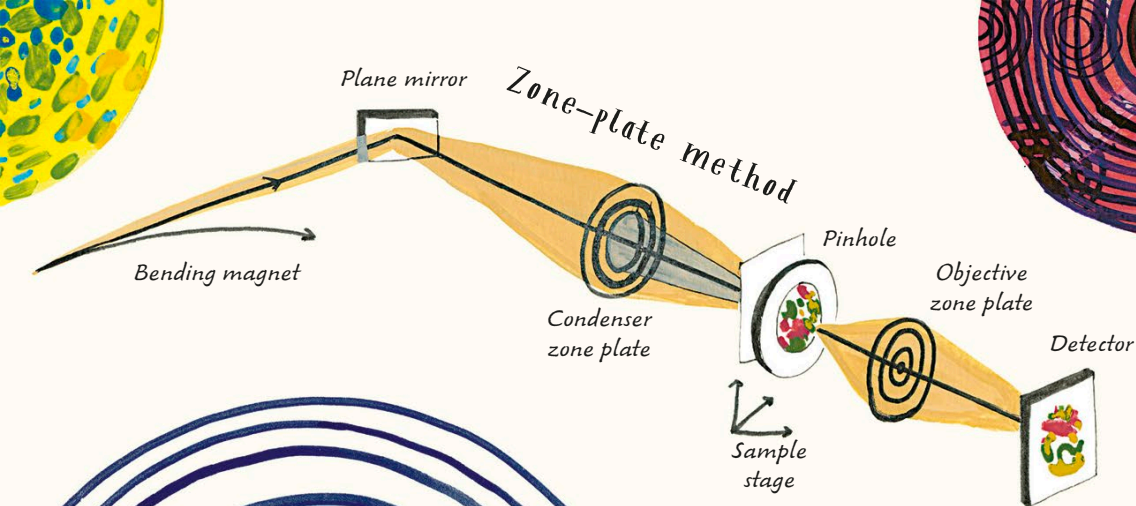




Modern microscopes

Today, the zone-plate technology Albert pioneered is used inside the world's highest-resolution X-ray microscopes, allowing us to see...

In the zone

Albert worked on a second method of focusing X-rays, using rings of material called zone-plates. When the rays hit the detector, they form patterns, revealing key information about the particle being studied.

X-ray vision

Albert helped develop a way to focus X-rays on an object by bouncing them off mirrors. It took many years to make these microscopes, but the results were amazing. A beam of X-rays could be focused on a spot 200 times narrower than a human hair! This allowed scientists to see much smaller details than they could with light microscopes. In addition,

X-rays can pass through many materials that block visible light. Using these microscopes, scientists could peer inside living cells without needing to destroy them.

Albert believed that the three most important qualities for a scientist were curiosity, creativity, and compassion. He helped spread this message after finishing his research career, working to improve science education around the world.

Zone-plate technology is used in telescopes that collect X-rays zooming toward the Earth from objects in space. They give us a better view of distant galaxies, from which very little visible light reaches the Earth.

